

Health Claims Forum Case Study Scenario

26 year old female

Occupation: Waitress.

DFA 10 Oct 2019 – Claims submitted in March 20

Deferred period 26 weeks.

Commencement date: 09/04/2020

Incapacity: Broken Ribs following an assault

Height 5ft 5

Weight 9st

Employee & Employer claim form completed in March 20.

Own occupation definition.

From claim form, claimant reports: Pain from broken ribs. Taking oramorph 5-10ml every 5-6hrs.

Able to perform light activities for short periods. Is allowed to drive, but doesn't due to pain.

Medical information:

OH reports

Pre absence – April 19 review with OH due to significant absence. Signed off with depression stress & Anxiety, taking mx and attending talking therapies. Struggling with day to day activities.

Feb 20: Absent with broken ribs. Experiencing lots of pain, taking strong pain killers. Can manage activities but cannot stay on feet. Advised that X-ray confirms ribs not yet healed. Mental Health under control.

March 20 – Continues to experience pain, stopped taking morphine now. Using OTC medication.

April 20 Ongoing pain recommenced morphine, managing daily chores, struggling to stand more than 30 minutes, mood effected.

GP/records obtained provided limited information. Only last 3 consultations.

Hx of anxiety and depression. Attended A&E with suspected broken hand in Sept 19. Did not wait. Hand swollen and bruised, reported fight with boyfriend, but no assault.

6 Oct 19 called 111 – nausea, vomiting, black out and hit head on floor. Ambulance dispatched. Paramedic reported episode of Bradycardia. Kept overnight for neuro and cardio observations. No CT scan required.

10 Oct 19 Fracture clinic report alleged assault by partner sustained multiple punch injuries. Tenderness to left chest wall. Right hand tender to metacarpal with some bruising. X-ray revealed Right base 5th metacarpal, closed fracture of 2 ribs left side.

April 20 reports ran out of oramorph which relieved pain. OTC meds no good. Prescribed Morphine 10mg

GP advised unable at this time to provide further information.

Direct contact.

Difficult to get her to articulated activity and daily structure. Evasive. Walks dog, washes and dyes her hair. Living with parents so does not need to do much. Reports ongoing significant rib pain. Has restraining order against boyfriend and case is due to go to court but delayed due to C19. Told pain could be due to nerves near ribs. Continues to take morphine and has now been prescribed pregabalin which is being increased. Barriers to RTW are walking, carrying, lifting and potential to be bumped into. Appointment with Consultant Orthopaedic delayed due to C19.

Issues:

Unclear why fractured ribs would not have healed within 3 months.

Unable to obtain objective functional capacity.

Self reporting of function unclear.

Impact from opioid pain medication

Biopsychosocial factors – Court case, job satisfaction, job situation due to C19

Unable to obtain further medical information or Consultant review.